

CONTENT CREATOR COMMUNITY · STRATEGY & ROADMAP · AUGUST 2026

What we build next.

Three decisions to make before we build anything, a role structure that scales past one person, a rewards ladder that costs less than cash and means more, and 126 things worth building — ranked, sequenced, and with the ones we should deliberately refuse to build listed at the end.

6

markets open

126

ideas, ranked

3

decisions first

90

day sequence

Where we actually are

Worth writing down, because half of the ideas people suggest for a community like this are already built and the other half assume something that is not.

Built and running

- One network, six markets nested inside it (UK & Ireland, Spain, Portugal, Germany, Romania, Nordics)
- Challenges with briefs, entries, leaderboards, prizes and a participation voucher
- Per-market rooms, worldwide rooms, DMs with a request model
- Connections, creator directory, live creator map, travel collab board
- Daily games, resource library, events, referrals, invoicing and payouts
- A points engine, wired but deliberately not switched on everywhere

The honest gaps

- There is no **identity ladder**. Everybody is “a creator” on day one and on day four hundred.
- Rewards are cash prizes for winning. Nothing rewards **showing up for a year**.
- The community produces video. It does not yet produce **reviews, photography, local knowledge, or product feedback** — all of which Tryp.com needs and none of which we ask for.
- We measure views. We do not measure **what a creator is worth to the business**, so we cannot argue for budget.
- Nothing physical has ever arrived in a creator’s hands.

The through-line for everything below. The programme currently pays for output. The next version should pay for *belonging*, because belonging is what produces output for years instead of for one campaign, and it is dramatically cheaper per unit of content.

How far do we gamify?

You asked whether to add points, leaderboards and the rest of it, or whether the views leaderboard is enough. This is the most consequential decision in the document, because it is very hard to reverse.

What the evidence says

The overjustification effect

Attaching points to something people already enjoy makes them dependent on the points, and *less* interested once the points stop. Creators post travel content because they like making travel content. Paying them in abstract currency for it is the one intervention that can reliably make them like it less.

Global leaderboards demotivate

A single ranked list of everybody motivates the top five and discourages everyone else. With 44 creators we would be publishing a weekly reminder to 39 people that they are not winning.

Badge inflation

Badges work when they are scarce and genuinely hard. A badge anybody can get for logging in signals that logging in is what we value. We already have effort-based badges on profiles; adding twenty more would devalue the ones that mean something.

Recommendation: do not build a points economy. Keep the **views leaderboard, per challenge** — it is not really gamification, it is the scoreboard of a competition with real money attached, and that is a different thing. Then add recognition in three forms that do not have the failure modes above: **seasonal** (resets, so everyone starts level), **segmented** (most improved, best first video, most helpful in the rooms — many winners, not one), and **milestone** (a ladder you climb by persistence rather than by beating anyone).

What that means concretely

BUILD	DO NOT BUILD
Per-challenge views leaderboard (already live)	A single all-time platform leaderboard
A season: 3 months, resets, its own table and its own small prize	Lifetime points that only ever go up
Milestones: 5 videos, 25 videos, one year, first million views	XP, levels, streaks, daily login rewards
Peer-nominated awards decided monthly by the community	Automated badges for trivial actions
Private progress (“you are 2 videos from your voucher”)	Public ranking of who posts least

The points engine already in the database stays. It is per-challenge and opt-in per brief, which is exactly the shape that survives this recommendation: a challenge can choose to be scored on points without the platform becoming a points game.

What we call people

You floated “Tryp.com Ambassador”, and a Campus Leaders or City Lead programme inside it. Both are right, and they are answering two different questions that should not share one name.

Identity: what you ARE

Earned by time and contribution. Everybody has one. It never expires and it is what goes in a creator’s Instagram bio. This is the ladder.

Role: what you DO

A job, with responsibilities and usually a budget or a stipend. Few people have one. It can be handed back. This is the org chart.

The identity ladder

NAME	HOW YOU GET THERE	WHAT IT UNLOCKS
Tryp.com Creator	Accepted into the programme	Briefs, rooms, the map, challenges
Tryp.com Ambassador	5 published videos <i>or</i> 3 months active	Merch drop, profile badge, early briefs, name on the site
Tryp.com Senior Ambassador	25 videos <i>or</i> a year in	Travel voucher, first refusal on paid work, a vote on next quarter’s briefs
Tryp.com Insider	Invitation only, ~10 people worldwide	Product roadmap access, an annual trip, direct line to the team

Four rungs, not seven. Every rung has to be worth putting in a bio, and the gap between rungs has to be a year of real work, or the top one means nothing.

The role structure

ROLE	WHAT IT IS
Tryp.com CCC Lead Content Creator Community Lead	You. One person, cannot be removed by anyone else, can hand it on. Built and live.
Country Manager e.g. “Spain Country Manager”	Runs one market: its briefs, its rooms, its recruitment, its budget. Paid or stipended. Titles are live now on /admin/team.
City Lead e.g. “Lisbon City Lead”	Volunteer. Runs meetups in one city, welcomes new creators there, knows the good spots. Rewarded in vouchers and status, not salary. This is the Airbnb Host Club model and it is the single best-proven structure in this space.
Campus Lead	A student who runs Tryp.com at one university. Deliberately a <i>separate programme</i> , not a rung — see below.

On Campus Leaders. Keep it separate from the creator ladder and give it its own name and its own front door. A campus programme is an *acquisition* channel: the goal is bookings from students, and the people who are good at it are organisers rather than videographers. Folding it into the creator ladder would blur what “Ambassador” means and put us in the position of ranking a great organiser below a mediocre filmmaker. Run it as **Tryp.com on Campus**, let people hold both, and let the two feed each other.

Other names worth changing

TODAY	BETTER	WHY
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Challenges	Keep	Everyone understands it and it is competitive in the right way
Collab board	Where we're going	"Collab" describes the mechanism; the name should describe the payoff
Roles (jobs page)	Paid work	Now collides with the role structure above, and "paid" is the part people care about
Rooms	Keep	Better than "channels", which is software language
Resource library	The playbook	A library is somewhere you browse; a playbook is something you use
Referrals	Bring someone in	Referral is affiliate-marketing language for a thing that is actually about friends

What the community is for, beyond content

Right now the community exists to produce videos for challenges. That is one use of 44 engaged travellers who love the brand, and it is not the most valuable one.

Eight things this community can do that a media buy cannot

1. Paid social creative

Whitelisted creator video run as ads from the creator's own handle typically beats studio-produced brand ads on cost per order. We are already producing the assets and using them once.

2. Destination content at scale

Every landing page for every city needs photography, a paragraph, and three things to do. We have people standing in those cities.

3. Reviews and trust

The single highest-converting asset in travel is other travellers. Creators can seed genuine, disclosed reviews of real trips.

4. Product feedback

44 people who book flights constantly and will tell you exactly where the funnel hurts, for free, if asked properly.

5. Local intelligence

Which routes are cheap right now, what is on in Porto in October, where the airport transfer is a trap. This is merchandising input.

6. Recruitment

Creators recruit creators far better than ads do. The referral flow exists; the reward is too small to move anyone.

7. Events and presence

A Tryp.com meetup in six cities is brand presence at a cost a media plan cannot approach.

8. Distribution for launches

A new market, a new feature, a sale: 44 accounts posting inside 48 hours is a launch channel we own.

Recommendation. Add exactly one non-video ask per quarter, and pay for it properly. Start with **destination content** (highest commercial value, easiest to brief, most reusable). Do not add all eight at once: a community asked for eight different things becomes a community that does none of them.

Milestones, rewards and merch

A ladder of things to reach for, costed. The principle throughout: **status and access are cheaper than cash and are remembered longer**, so cash should be reserved for the moments where nothing else will do.

The milestone ladder

MILESTONE	REWARD	WHY THIS REWARD
First video published	Welcome pack: stickers, luggage tag, handwritten note	The cheapest loyalty you will ever buy. Physical post is disproportionately memorable.
3 videos	Profile badge + featured in the newsletter	Free. Recognition, at the point where people decide whether this is for them.
5 videos / 3 months	Ambassador status + the merch drop	The rung that has to feel like arriving. Merch is the visible proof.
10 videos	£50 travel voucher	Spendable on the product, so the cost is marginal rather than face value.
25 videos / 1 year	Senior Ambassador + £150 voucher + first refusal on paid work	Access is worth more than the voucher and costs nothing.
1M cumulative views	Flight to a Tryp.com trip, or a £300 voucher	The headline milestone. Should be rare, public and photographed.
2 years active	Insider invitation	Time served, not output. Rewards the quiet reliable people the leaderboard never sees.
Brought in 3 creators	£100 voucher + "Recruiter" note on profile	Current referral reward is too small to change behaviour.

Merch: what, and when

Tier 1 — Welcome

Sticker sheet, luggage tag, card. ~£3.
Everyone who publishes once.

Tier 2 — Ambassador

Heavyweight tee or cap, packing cube, enamel pin. ~£25. Earned, never sold.

Tier 3 — Senior / Insider

Numbered jacket or holdall with the creator's name. ~£70. Fewer than 15 a year.

Three rules that decide whether merch works

- **Never sell it.** The moment it is purchasable it stops being a marker of status and becomes a t-shirt. A shop is a different business; this is a badge.
- **Make it good enough to wear when not filming.** Cheap merch is worse than no merch: it tells people what they are worth. One excellent item beats five printed ones.
- **Number and name it.** "Ambassador 014" embroidered inside the collar costs almost nothing and converts a garment into an artefact.

Practical note: merch needs an address, a size and a delivery status per creator. That is a small feature (nos. 20–23 below) and it should ship before the first order, not after.

126 things worth building

Grouped by what they are for. **NOW** is the next 90 days, **NEXT** is this year, **LATER** is worth writing down but not worth starting.

A. Challenges and briefs

01 – 14

1	Brief templates — a new challenge starts from a proven shape rather than a blank form	NOW
2	Scheduled challenges — write it in August, it opens in September on its own	NOW
3	Multi-market challenges — one brief, six leaderboards, one prize pot	NEXT
4	Head-to-head weeks — Spain versus Portugal on combined views	NEXT
5	Brief comments — questions answered publicly, so the same one is not asked eleven times	NOW
6	Draft review — optional feedback on a cut before it is posted	NEXT
7	Reference reel — three examples of what winning looks like, attached to the brief	NOW
8	Auto view-count import — stop logging views by hand	NEXT
9	Entry deadline reminders — 72h, 24h, 3h, only to people who have not entered	NOW
10	Mid-challenge standings — provisional, clearly labelled, which the code already supports	NOW
11	Themed seasons — “Autumn city breaks” running across three challenges	NEXT
12	Sponsor-funded briefs — a tourism board pays the prize pot	LATER
13	Rematch — rerun a brief that worked, a year on, with the old winners as judges	LATER
14	Challenge post-mortem — what won and why, published to everyone who entered	NOW

B. Rewards, milestones and merch

15 – 28

15	Milestone engine — the ladder in chapter 04, tracked and awarded automatically	NOW
16	Private progress — “2 videos from your voucher”, visible only to you	NOW
17	Voucher wallet — issue, track and redeem Tryp.com credit in one place	NOW
18	Milestone moment — a full-screen celebration and a shareable card when you hit one	NEXT
19	Anniversary recognition — one year in the programme, said publicly	NOW
20	Shipping details — address and size on the profile, private, encrypted	NOW
21	Merch fulfilment queue — who is owed what, what has shipped	NOW
22	Tracking notifications — “your Ambassador pack is on its way”	NEXT
23	Unboxing prompt — the pack arriving is itself a piece of content, so ask	NEXT
24	Peer-nominated monthly awards — most helpful, best first video, best comeback	NEXT
25	Seasonal table — resets quarterly so everyone starts level	NEXT
26	Surprise upgrades — unannounced rewards for quiet consistency	NEXT
27	Prize history on profile — everything you have won, in one place	LATER

28 **Charity option** — take the voucher or send it somewhere

LATER

C. Roles, progression and recognition

29 – 40

29 **The identity ladder** — Creator / Ambassador / Senior / Insider, shown everywhere a name is

NOW

30 **City Lead role** — a volunteer job with a remit, a budget and a handbook

NEXT

31 **Tryp.com on Campus** — a separate programme with its own application and its own metrics

LATER

32 **Role applications** — apply to run a city, rather than waiting to be asked

NEXT

33 **Public team page** — who runs each market, with faces and titles

NOW

34 **Ambassador directory on tryp.com** — a real backlink and a real bragging right

NEXT

35 **Verified badge on socials** — a supplied bio line and link everyone uses

NOW

36 **Manager handover** — hand a market to somebody else without an admin doing it in SQL

NEXT

37 **Role stipends** — recurring payouts through the existing invoice system

NEXT

38 **Mentor pairing** — every new creator gets an Ambassador for their first month

NEXT

39 **Alumni status** — leaving well, so people come back

LATER

40 **Creator council** — six elected creators who see the roadmap before it is built

LATER

D. Community and rooms

41 – 52

41 **Threads in rooms** — one busy day currently buries a week of conversation

NEXT

42 **Unread counts per room** — the single most-missed piece of chat furniture

NOW

43 **Voice notes** — creators are talkers; typing is a tax

NEXT

44 **Polls in rooms** — already exist for events, not for chat

NOW

45 **Weekly prompt** — an automatic question every Monday so the room is never cold

NOW

46 **City rooms** — creatable on demand once three creators share a city

NEXT

47 **Room digests** — a weekly email of what you missed, for the 60% who do not open chat

NEXT

48 **Pinned welcome** — every room explains itself to the person who just arrived

NOW

49 **Office hours** — a recurring live call, per market, in the calendar

NEXT

50 **Introduce yourself flow** — guided, so the first post is never a blank page

NOW

51 **Quiet-creator nudge** — private, warm, never public shaming

NEXT

52 **Community guidelines** — written down, agreed at signup, enforceable

NOW

E. Discovery and connections

53 – 62

53 **Mutual connections** — shipped today; the strongest signal there is

DONE

54 **Creator search by skill** — drone, editing, food, hiking, languages

NEXT

55 **“Who should I meet” digest** — three people a month, with the reason

NEXT

56 **Group DMs** — three creators planning one trip currently cannot talk in one place

NEXT

57	Profile prompts — “the trip that changed how I film” beats an empty bio	NEXT
58	Language matching — increasingly load-bearing across six markets	NEXT
59	Nearby alerts — opt-in, when a connection lands in your city	NEXT
60	Endorsements — vouch for someone you have actually filmed with	LATER
61	Creator of the week — rotating, everyone before anyone repeats	NOW
62	New joiner spotlight — arrival is the moment somebody is most willing to connect	NOW

F. Travel and collaboration

63 – 72

63	Trip overlap alerts — on the board today; should also be a notification	NOW
64	Open invitations — “I have a spare seat in the car to Sintra”	NEXT
65	Meetup creation — turn an overlap into an event in one tap	NEXT
66	Trip cost splitting — who paid for the Airbnb, settled in the app	LATER
67	Deal alerts on planned trips — the product, delivered into the plan	NEXT
68	Trip reports — what it cost, what was worth it, published to the community	NEXT
69	Collab requests — “I need someone to film me in Berlin”, answerable	NEXT
70	Route sharing — the actual flights and times, so somebody can copy it	LATER
71	Group trips — Tryp.com organises one a year and creators apply	LATER
72	Past trips archive — searchable, so “has anybody done Tirana” has an answer	NEXT

G. Learning and creator growth

73 – 82

73	The playbook — the library, restructured into paths rather than a pile	NOW
74	Hook bank — opening lines that measurably worked, searchable by destination	NOW
75	Teardowns — a winning video annotated second by second	NEXT
76	Workshops — monthly live session with somebody good, recorded	NEXT
77	Editing presets — LUTs, captions, sound, in Tryp.com’s look	NEXT
78	Music guidance — what is safe to use, kept current	NOW
79	Your stats — a creator’s own performance over time, honestly	NEXT
80	Feedback on request — ask the team to look at a video that underperformed	NEXT
81	Brand and legal kit — logos, disclosure wording, what not to claim	NOW
82	Certification — a short course that ends in a credential worth putting on a CV	LATER

H. Markets and expansion

83 – 92

83	Market launch checklist — the thing a new Country Manager is handed on day one	NOW
84	Market health dashboard — active creators, entries, views, cost per view, per market	NOW
85	Recruitment funnel per market — applications, approvals, first video, by country	NEXT

86	Local language rooms — the English-only rule is right for Worldwide and wrong for Romania	NEXT
87	Local currency prizes — RON for Romania, SEK for the Nordics	NEXT
88	Market landing pages — a public page per market to recruit into	NEXT
89	Waitlists for closed markets — capture demand in Italy before opening Italy	NOW
90	Manager handbook — what to do in week one, week two, month two	NOW
91	Cross-market spotlights — a Spanish video shown to the Nordics on purpose	NEXT
92	Market retirement — how to close one kindly, if a market does not work	LATER
I. Data, insight and proving value		93 – 102
93	Cost per view, tracked properly — the number that justifies the whole programme	NOW
94	Attributed bookings — per-creator links, so we know what content is worth	NOW
95	Content library — every video ever made, searchable and rights-cleared	NEXT
96	Usage rights on file — what we may run as an ad, agreed up front	NOW
97	Quarterly board pack — generated, not assembled by hand the night before	NEXT
98	Retention cohorts — are creators from March still posting in September	NEXT
99	Churn early warning — who has gone quiet, before they have gone	NEXT
100	Creator NPS — asked quarterly, acted on visibly	NOW
101	Benchmark pack — what good looks like, so creators can place themselves	LATER
102	Public annual report — what the community did this year, published	LATER
J. Marketing Tryp.com through the community		103 – 116
103	Whitelisted creator ads — run the best entries as paid social from the creator's handle	NOW
104	Destination content commissions — paid, briefed, reusable on tryp.com	NOW
105	Creator photography bank — stills for landing pages, licensed properly	NEXT
106	Reviews programme — genuine, disclosed, from real trips	NEXT
107	Creator-written destination guides — SEO that a content agency cannot fake	NEXT
108	Launch squad — a standing group that posts within 48h of any launch	NOW
109	Product feedback loop — a monthly question from the product team, answered	NOW
110	Route and deal intelligence — creators flag what is cheap; merchandising uses it	NEXT
111	Meetups in six cities — brand presence at a cost no media plan can match	NEXT
112	Creator takeovers — of the Tryp.com channels, one week each	NEXT
113	Affiliate layer — commission on bookings, on top of prizes rather than instead	NEXT
114	Tourism board partnerships — they fund the trip, we bring the creators	LATER
115	Press and case studies — the programme itself is a story worth placing	LATER

116 **Creator-led newsletter** — written by the community, sent to customers

LATER

K. Platform craft and trust

117 – 126

117 **Notification settings that make sense** — per market, per type, in one place

NOW

118 **Email digest instead of per-event mail** — one good email beats nine

NOW

119 **Onboarding rebuilt around the first video** — not around filling in a profile

NOW

120 **Offline and slow-network handling** — creators are on hotel wifi and roaming

NEXT

121 **Full mobile pass on every legacy page** — the network shell is done; the rest is not

NOW

122 **Accessibility audit** — contrast, focus order, screen readers, reduced motion

NEXT

123 **Search across everything** — the palette exists; it should reach messages and resources

NEXT

124 **Data export and deletion, self-serve** — already built; keep it working as the network grows

NEXT

125 **Status page** — when a challenge deadline is near, silence during an outage is expensive

LATER

126 **Payout automation** — prizes and stipends without a human moving money by hand

NEXT

What we should refuse to build

A roadmap without this section is a wish list. Each of these is a reasonable idea that would make the product worse.

A universal points economy

Covered in chapter 01. It would make the intrinsically motivated creators — the good ones — care less.

An all-time global leaderboard

Motivates five people and quietly tells 39 they are losing.

Streaks and daily login rewards

This is not a language app. Punishing somebody for being on a flight is absurd.

A merch shop

The moment it is purchasable it stops being status. Sell merch and you have a small clothing business and no badge.

An in-app video editor

Creators have CapCut and Premiere and are better at them than we will ever be.

Auto-generated content

The whole asset class we sell is “a real person went there”.

Public follower counts

Turns a community of peers into a hierarchy in one deploy, and the briefs do not care.

Ranking creators publicly by earnings

The fastest way to make people who like each other stop.

The next 90 days

Everything marked **NOW** above, sequenced so each month ends with something a creator would actually notice.

Month 1 — Say what people are

- Ship the identity ladder and backfill everybody into it (29)
- Milestone engine plus private progress (15, 16)
- Shipping details, sizes and the fulfilment queue (20, 21)
- Order the welcome pack and the Ambassador drop
- Community guidelines, written and agreed at signup (52)

Month 2 — Make the rooms worth opening

- Unread counts, pinned welcomes, the weekly prompt (42, 45, 48)
- Brief templates, scheduled challenges, reference reels (1, 2, 7)
- Deadline reminders to non-entrants only (9)
- The playbook restructure and the hook bank (73, 74)
- First welcome packs land in the post

Month 3 — Prove what it is worth

- Cost per view and attributed bookings, properly tracked (93, 94)
- Usage rights captured up front, then the first whitelisted ads (96, 103)
- First paid destination-content commissions (104)
- Market health dashboard and the launch checklist (83, 84)
- Creator NPS, asked and answered in public (100)

The one number to watch. Not views, and not entries. **The share of creators who published something this month.** A programme where 80% of people post is worth more than one where 20% post twice as much, because the first one compounds and the second one is four freelancers and a mailing list.

Sources

GetYourGuide Creator Community · Airbnb Ambassadors, Host Clubs and Community Leaders · Duolingo volunteer ambassador programme · research on the overjustification effect, leaderboard demotivation and badge inflation in community gamification · industry data on influencer whitelisting and creator-led paid social performance · ambassador tier and milestone-reward practice across DTC and travel brands. Reviewed August 2026.